

Relativity and Electromagnetism Homework Assignment 4

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March 2026

Problem 1

The general solution for the potential is of the form:

$$V(r, \theta) = \sum_{l=0}^{\infty} \left(A_l r^l + \frac{B_l}{r^{l+1}} \right) P_l(\cos \theta)$$

analyzing the problem we can immediately see that the potential must be of the form:

$$V(r, \theta) = A_2 r^2 + \frac{B_2}{r^3} P_2(\cos \theta) + A_3 r^3 + \frac{B_3}{r^4} P_3(\cos \theta)$$

This is because, at the radius a sphere, the potential must be $V(a, \theta) = V_a P_2(\cos \theta)$, and at the radius b sphere, the potential must be $V(b, \theta) = V_b P_3(\cos \theta)$. there thus has to be a P_2 and P_3 term, and no other terms.

We can now use these boundary conditions to find the coefficients first at the radius a sphere, we find that:

$$\begin{cases} A_2 a^2 + \frac{B_2}{a^3} = V_a \\ A_3 a^3 + \frac{B_3}{a^4} = 0 \end{cases}$$

and at the radius b sphere, we find that:

$$\begin{cases} A_2 b^2 + \frac{B_2}{b^3} = 0 \\ A_3 b^3 + \frac{B_3}{b^4} = V_b \end{cases}$$

combining these two systems of equations we find that:

$$\begin{cases} A_2 = \frac{V_a a^3}{a^5 - b^5} \\ B_2 = \frac{V_a a^5 b^3}{b^5 - a^5} \end{cases}$$

and

$$\begin{cases} A_3 = \frac{V_b b^4}{b^7 - a^7} \\ B_3 = \frac{V_b b^4 a^7}{a^7 - b^7} \end{cases}$$

plugging these coefficients back into the general solution we find that the potential in the cavity is given by:

$$V(r, \theta) = \left(\frac{a^3}{a^5 - b^5} r^2 + \frac{a^3 b^5}{b^5 - a^5} \frac{1}{r^3} \right) V_a P_2(\cos \theta) + \left(\frac{b^4}{b^7 - a^7} r^3 + \frac{b^4 a^7}{a^7 - b^7} \frac{1}{r^4} \right) V_b P_3(\cos \theta)$$

Problem 2

for this charge configuration we find that the position vector of the charge at $z = a$, $z = 0$ and $z = -a$ are respectively given by:

$$\begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ a \end{pmatrix}, \quad \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ -a \end{pmatrix}$$

monopole moment

The monopole moment can be calculated as:

$$q = \sum_i q_i = 2q - 2q = 0$$

We thus find that the monopole moment of this charge configuration vanishes.

dipole moment

The dipole moment can be calculated as:

$$\mathbf{p} = \sum_i q_i \mathbf{r}_i = 2q \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} - q \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ a \end{pmatrix} - q \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ -a \end{pmatrix} = \mathbf{0}$$

We thus find that the dipole moment of this charge configuration also vanishes.

quadrupole moment

We can calculate the elements of the quadrupole moment as:

$$Q_{ij} = \frac{1}{2} \sum_k q_k (3r_{k,i} r_{k,j} - \delta_{ij} r_k^2)$$

for the diagonal elements we find that:

$$Q_{xx} = Q_{yy} = qa^2, \quad Q_{zz} = -2qa^2$$

for the above off-diagonal elements we find that:

$$Q_{xy} = Q_{xz} = Q_{yz} = 0$$

because the quadrupole moment is symmetric, we find that the quadrupole moment of this charge configuration is given by:

$$\mathbf{Q} = \begin{pmatrix} qa^2 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & qa^2 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & -2qa^2 \end{pmatrix}$$

Problem 3

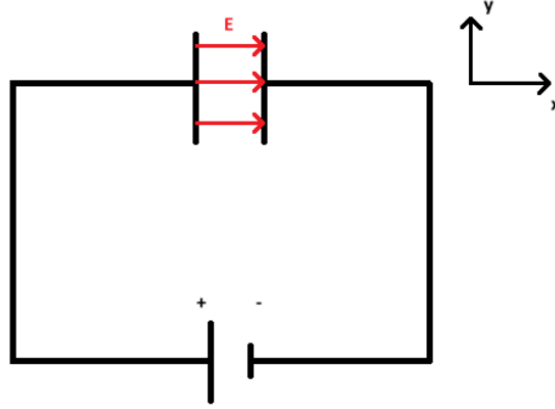


Figure 1: Circuit diagram of the problem

a.

Electric field

Per definition of the potential difference we have that:

$$V(d) - V(0) = - \int_0^d \mathbf{E} \cdot d\mathbf{l}$$

where $V(0)$ is the potential at the positive plate and $V(d)$ is the potential at the negative plate. Because the electric field is uniform between the plates, we can write that:

$$V = V(d) - V(0) = -E \int_0^d dl = -Ed$$

Than looking at the circuit, we see that the electric field is pointing in the x-direction and thus we can write that:

$$\mathbf{E} = -\frac{V}{d} \hat{\mathbf{x}}$$

Polarization

via the relation between the electric field and the polarization:

$$\mathbf{P} = \epsilon_0(\chi_1 + \chi_3 E^2) \mathbf{E}$$

we find that the polarization can be written in terms of the potential as:

$$\mathbf{P} = -\epsilon_0 \left(\chi_1 + \chi_3 \frac{V^2}{d^2} \right) \frac{V}{d} \hat{\mathbf{x}}$$

Displacement field

Again via the relation between the electric field, the polarization and the displacement field:

$$\mathbf{D} = \epsilon_0 \mathbf{E} + \mathbf{P}$$

We find that the displacement field can be written in terms of the potential as:

$$\mathbf{D} = -\epsilon_0 \left(1 + \chi_1 + \chi_3 \frac{V^2}{d^2} \right) \frac{V}{d} \hat{\mathbf{x}}$$

b.

Free charge

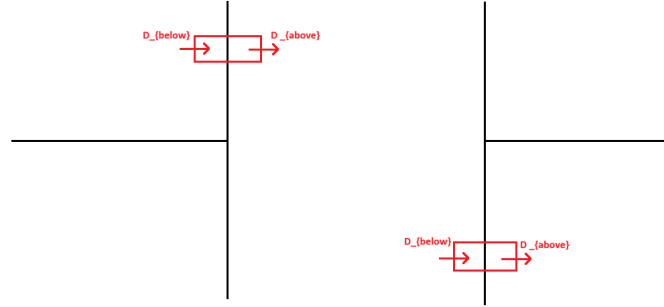


Figure 2: Circuit diagram of the problem with the free charge

In the section about boundary conditions (section 4.3.3 edition 4 of Griffiths) we find that the free charge density on the surface of the positive plate can be calculated as:

$$\sigma_f = D_{above}^\perp - D_{below}^\perp$$

for the positive plate, we only have an $D_{above}^\perp$ component, because the electric field is zero outside the plates. We also have that the displacement field is already perpendicular to the surface of the plate, thus we can write that:

$$\sigma_f(\text{positive plate}) = D_{above}^\perp = -\epsilon_0 \left(1 + \chi_1 + \chi_3 \frac{V^2}{d^2} \right) \frac{V}{d}$$

for the negative plate, we only have a $D_{below}^\perp$ component, again because the electric field is zero outside the plates. We also have that the displacement field is already perpendicular to the surface of the plate, thus we can write that:

$$\sigma_f(\text{negative plate}) = -D_{below}^\perp = \epsilon_0 \left(1 + \chi_1 + \chi_3 \frac{V^2}{d^2} \right) \frac{V}{d}$$

Bound charge

The bounded charge surface density is defined as:

$$\sigma_b = \mathbf{P} \cdot \hat{\mathbf{n}}$$

Where $\hat{\mathbf{n}}$ is the normal vector to the surface of the plate, pointing outwards. For the positive plate, we have that $\hat{\mathbf{n}} = \hat{\mathbf{x}}$, thus we can write that:

$$\sigma_b(\text{positive plate}) = \mathbf{P} \cdot \hat{\mathbf{n}} = -\epsilon_0 \left(\chi_1 + \chi_3 \frac{V^2}{d^2} \right) \frac{V}{d}$$

For the negative plate, we have that $\hat{\mathbf{n}} = -\hat{\mathbf{x}}$, thus we can write that:

$$\sigma_b(\text{negative plate}) = \mathbf{P} \cdot \hat{\mathbf{n}} = \epsilon_0 \left(\chi_1 + \chi_3 \frac{V^2}{d^2} \right) \frac{V}{d}$$

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